

NATHAN BUNKER

R&D, SOFTWARE, AND STANDARDS LEADER

Dandelion Software & Research

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LEAN WITH RESOURCES • COLLABORATIVE AND DECISIVE • COMFORTABLE WITH INCOMPLETE INFORMATION

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I help small organizations and ambitious teams turn promising ideas into durable technical capabilities. I work best when the problem matters but the path, staffing, or structure is incomplete. I adapt to what is missing, whether that means research, architecture, software development, troubleshooting, facilitation, training, or communication, until the approach is proven and a permanent owner can take it forward. My goal is not to become indispensable. It is to leave the organization stronger.

HOW I CREATE VALUE

PROJECT FORMATION & R&D Recognize high potential problems, gather evidence, define the opportunity, and create a credible first path forward.	TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE & SOFTWARE Translate complex requirements into practical systems, build the first useful capability, and resolve technical barriers.
STANDARDS & CONSENSUS Interpret standards, reconcile competing perspectives, facilitate decisions, and move groups from discussion into implementation.	ORGANIZATIONAL ENABLEMENT Multiply the effectiveness of existing staff through better tools, processes, training, documentation, and durable handoff.

SELECTED IMPACT

Measurement & Improvement Identified that public health immunization systems following the same standard behaved very differently in practice. Designed early measurement work with Indian Health Service, produced evidence that changed national understanding, and helped turn the concept into a major CDC funded program at AIRA. Joined AIRA as the first hire for the new initiative and transferred the project foundation so it could scale.	Aggregate Analysis Reporting Tool (AART) Designed and built the platform that transformed measurement from a labor intensive service into a scalable operational program. AART became the backbone of AIRA's Measurement & Improvement work and now supports a multidisciplinary team. The resulting standardization helped immunization systems absorb dramatically increased reporting volumes during the COVID-19 response.
Emerging Standards & InteropHub Created and successfully positioned a program for helping the immunization community move from a mature legacy standard toward newer approaches such as FHIR. Built the topic, community, and facilitation model, then began developing InteropHub to make the process durable, scalable, and less dependent on a single facilitator.	International Vaccine Codes (IVC) Formed an international initiative to address inconsistent vaccine coding across countries and systems. Built partnerships in the United States, France, Canada, the Netherlands, and other countries; led an in person working meeting in Bordeaux; and continues advancing the work despite limited institutional funding.

HOW I WORK

FILL THE GAP Step into the role a project needs, including work that would normally be divided among several specialists.	PROVE, THEN TRANSFER Establish that an approach works, document it, and prepare the right person or team to become the permanent owner.	NICE AND LEAN Collaborate respectfully, use limited resources carefully, and keep work moving without waiting for perfect conditions.
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**I DO NOT REPLACE THE WORKFORCE.
I MULTIPLY IT, THEN LEAVE THE WORK STRONGER AND READY FOR A PERMANENT OWNER.**

NATHAN BUNKER

R&D, Software, and Standards Leader | Dandelion Software & Research

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

American Immunization Registry Association | 2015–Present

Senior Technical Standards Architect; Senior Technical Project Manager, 2015–2023

- Provides technical leadership across software, national and international standards, emerging technology, and organizational capability development.
- Creates new programs and systems, including Measurement & Improvement, Emerging Standards, AART, and InteropHub, that allow small teams to operate at greater scale.
- Co-chairs an international HL7 standards work group and advises state programs, vendors, national partners, and international collaborators.
- Develops training, facilitates difficult technical discussions, mentors staff, and turns informal practices into repeatable processes that others can own.

Dandelion Software & Research | 2007–2015; 2026–Present

Independent R&D, software, standards, and technical consulting

- Supported 12 public and private clients, often simultaneously, in software development, integration, architecture, standards, facilitation, training, troubleshooting, and project formation.
- Worked across hospitals, government programs, nonprofit organizations, technology vendors, and consulting firms while remaining connected to a shared public health community.
- Converted successful consulting initiatives into durable programs and transferred the work, intellectual property, and relationships into AIRA when joining the organization in 2015.
- Selected clients and partners included Indian Health Service, Texas Children’s Hospital, Michigan Care Improvement Registry, Massachusetts Immunization Information System, Northrop Grumman, Public Health Informatics Institute, STC, and AIRA.

Scientific Technologies Corporation | 2003–2011

Software Developer and Technical Lead

Developed reusable HL7 parsing and interface software that gave products a new technical capability and provided technical leadership across more than 140 interface projects in 18 states and jurisdictions.

SELECTED SYSTEMS & PRODUCTS

Dandelion Daily

A multi-project productivity and time-management application grounded in Getting Things Done principles. The system is central to Nathan’s ability to manage a broad portfolio and is being prepared for wider use through DSR.

InteropHub

A community and project coordination platform designed to organize emerging standards, participation, decisions, and progress across distributed technical groups.

IIS Sandbox

A reference implementation used to test and demonstrate immunization information exchange.

AART

A centralized measurement and reporting platform that became foundational to AIRA’s national interoperability program.

Lone Star Forecaster

Stand alone application that can evaluate an immunization history and return recommendations of vaccinations complete and due next for a patient.

Step Into CDSi

Implements the Clinical Decision Support for Immunizations (CDSi) logic in a system that demonstrates and realizes CDC process for immunization evaluation and recommendations.

Message Quality Evaluator (MQE)

Implements the Clinical Decision Support for Immunizations (CDSi) logic in a system that demonstrates and realizes CDC process for immunization evaluation and recommendations.

LEADERSHIP & REACH

- Co-chair, HL7 international standards work group
- Founder and lead organizer, International Vaccine Codes initiative
- Collaboration with Syadem and international partners; working meeting led in Bordeaux, France
- Participation in PAHO meetings and technical presentations in Spanish
- Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Arizona State University

TECHNICAL FOUNDATION

Java, SQL, web applications, APIs, data integration, HL7, FHIR, technical standards, rapid prototyping, and AI assisted research and development.

SELECTED RECOGNITION

- AIRA Volunteer Service Award, 2012
- Co-author, The Texas Children’s Hospital Immunization Forecaster: Conceptualization to Implementation, American Journal of Public Health, 2014
- Frequent national and international presenter; technical presentations delivered in English and Spanish

BEST ENGAGEMENTS

- Small organizations or groups with more ambition than capacity
- High potential work where opportunity is clear but the path is not
- Focused engagements that establish direction, prove a capability, and prepare a durable handoff
- Teams that want a workforce multiplier rather than routine staff augmentation

NICE AND LEAN: RESPECTFUL COLLABORATION, PRACTICAL SCOPE, VISIBLE PROGRESS, AND DURABLE HANDOFF.